First Congregational Church of St. Albans (FCC) is a welcoming community of spiritual seekers, believers, and doubters.

Please know that no *matter who you are or where you are on life's journey, you're welcome here.*

First Congregational Church Vision Statement

To create an open and loving community that encourages a joyous exploration with God.
To work together to care for and nurture the wider community.

First Congregational Church Mission Statement

Our mission as a community resource church is to provide a safe place for spiritual exploration and personal growth. To affirm the value of each person and to meet them where they are.
To connect to the community through personal service, giving, and pastoral care.

Please feel free to contact us:
Administrative Office: Monday: 2pm-4pm; Tuesday 9am-2pm; Wednesday 10am-Noon; Thursday 9am-2pm; Friday 10am-Noon.
Church Office Phone Number: 802-524-4555
Pastor Jessica's Office Hours: By Appointment
Email: pastorjessica@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
For urgent pastoral matters call Pastor Jessica at 207-632-5544.

Our worship service is broadcast over the local public access channel 1079 on Sundays at 4 PM.

Scripture Reader: Stephen McLaughlin

UNITED CHURCH OF CHRIST

First Congregational Church of St. Albans

An open and affirming community.



"We welcome you and serve all through faith."

Worship with us:

March 17, 2024

10 am

Rev. Jessica Moore, Pastor
Stephan Conrady, Organist
Dr. Kevin Dirth, Choir Director
Monica Newton, Office Manager

27 Church Street, St. Albans, VT 05478
802-524-4555
info@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
www.firstcongregationalstalbans.org

We Gather as God's People

Centering Words**:** "The wise ones fashioned speech with their thought, sifting it as grain is sifted through a sieve." – Buddha

❖ BEGINNING OF SERVICE ❖

THE PREPARATION

The beginning of the prelude is a call to enter into the spirit of prayer and community.

Prelude

Welcome and Announcements

Call To Worship

All: Within this community

One: We experience God's unconditional love

All: Within this community

One: We rejoice in the risen Christ

All: Within this community

One: We awaken to the Holy Spirit

All: Within this community

One: We join together in worship

Welcome to all visitors: We are delighted that you chose to worship with us today and are strengthened by your participation in our service!

If you are new to First Congregational Church of St. Albans, please sign the guest book in the narthex (main entrance of the church).

If you would like more information about our church and its programs or would like to receive our Morning Reflections, and weekly e-newsletter, "From the Manse," please fill out a Welcome Card and place it in the Offering tray (be sure to include your email address).

After the service please join us for fellowship, conversation, coffee, and refreshments.

*Please Stand If You Are Able

[1]UCC, Worship Ways

Music, Copyright permissions: CCLI #4799426 and SJMP #14586

Mission Highlight
The Welcome Home Initiative:
First Congregational Church of St. Albans is a founding member of the Welcome Home Initiative (WH). WH provides people transitioning from homelessness to permanent housing in Franklin and Grand Isle Counties of Vermont with new- home essentials (mop, broom, dishes, cleaners, trash can, pots & pans, etc.), personal items (shampoo, deodorant, etc.), and a full pantry, fridge, and freezer stock of food.

The Welcome Home Initiative is a collaboration among:
- ➔ Franklin/Grand Isle CVOEO- Community Action
- ➔ First Congregational Church of St Albans
- ➔ Grace Episcopal Church, Sheldon
- ➔ Sheldon Methodist Food Shelf
- ➔ Holy Trinity Episcopal Church, Swanton

As well as other churches and businesses that have donated to the Initiative. Including, Adorn Aprons and Franklin County Quilt Guild.

WH works with local housing case workers from:
- ➢ F/GI Community Action
- ➢ Voices Against Violence
- ➢ Samaritan House
- ➢ Restorative Justice Center
- ➢ Pathways
- ➢ Reach-Up

First Congregational Church functions as the fiscal agent, collection center and pick-up hub for the program. WH serves on average 6-7 individuals/families to be housed a month.

Morning Prayer **(Unison)**
God of grains and grace, we gather today seeking to follow in the way of Jesus. The path he chose for his disciples was one of service and it requires of us that we lay down our desires, our ambitions, and serve you with our whole heart. May our worship this day inspire our dying and rising with you as we seek to love and serve like Jesus. May it be so. Amen.

Hymn*
"Praise to the Living God" (1, 3, 4) NCH 8

Prayer of Confession[1] **(Unison)**
God of love, we confess that our ego can all too often get in the way of our ability to serve you and others with our lives. Our false self is driven by our lack of trust in you to provide for our every need. We rely on our own strength. But, our true self can let go and be formed anew by your love. Forgive us our false ways and transform us and raise us to new life. Amen.

Pause for Reflection

Words of Assurance

Passing of the Peace

THE MESSAGE

Time with Children of All Ages

Anthem *Prayer of St. Francis* *Carol McClure*

Scripture Readings
Jeremiah 31:31-34 & John 12:20-33

Morning Reflection
Lost and Found

Hymn*

"There is a Balm in Gilead" NCH 553

THE THANKSGIVING

Sharing Our Joys and Concerns

Choral Call To Prayer

Hear Our Prayer, O lord D. Welpton

Pastor's Prayer~

Lord's Prayer

Our Father who art in heaven, hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come, thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom and the power and the glory, forever, Amen.

Choral Response To Prayer

"*Thou wilt keep him in perfect peace, whose mind is stayed on thee.*"

Scottish Psalter, 1615

OFFERTORY

Doxology

Praise God from whom all blessing flow
Praise God all creatures here below;
Praise God above, all heavenly hosts:
Creator, Christ and Holy Ghost. Amen.

Offertory Prayer

THE DEPARTURE

Hymn*

"Lift High the Cross" (1, 3, 5) NCH 198

Benediction

Postlude Danny Boy

❖ END OF SERVICE ❖

Announcements:

A Special Note of Gratitude From All of Us At FCC:

★ **Thank you— Sandy Cristman, Amanda Parrott, Jessica Pecor, Chauncey Scates, Valerie Walden, Thank You for participating in, "How to Help Your Church Grow" workshop last Saturday, the first day of a year long initiative — we can't wait to see where this will take us!**

March 26

7pm at the Welden Theater

Just Getting By, a local film about food insecurity will be shown at the Welden Theater. Donations of non-perishable food accepted for NW Family Foods.

Holy Week Schedule

March 24 at 10am

Palm Sunday --marks our return to the Sanctuary!

March 28 at 6:30pm

Maundy Thursday Pot-Luck and Tennebrae Service

March 31:

6:30am Sunrise Easter Service at Hard'Ack with St. Paul's and St. Luke's

10:00am Easter Service at 10am in the Sanctuary

Music Notes

The writer of today's hymn is Carol McLure, a contemporary composer living in Nashville. In addition, she is a professional harpist who teaches at the University of Louisville.

Wi-Fi:

Fellowship Hall

fellowshiphall123

